

Care Workshop

Sound Briefing—Project “Ooops!”

Setting: Café Le Jardin de Sonia | **Team:** Kostas, Luca & Carla

OVERALL STORYLINE OF THE PROJECT

Over the years, Sonias café has become a whole world filled with gifts, but the sad time has now arrived for the place to close. When the very first object ever given to the café shatters, a new customer starts putting the pieces back together. As the pieces come back together, the café’s beautiful history unfolds, but it also brings us progressively closer to its end.

SOUND CONCEPT

The experience takes place across two scenes: outside and inside the café. Sound should act as an additional storytelling layer alongside the visuals, reinforcing the emotional contrast between these two spaces.

Outside Atmosphere: cold · dull · distant · slightly melancholic

Inside Atmosphere: warm · welcoming · cozy · comforting · slow

The soundscape consists of three main layers:

- 1. Ambient Backgrounds:** Two environmental soundscapes that establish the atmosphere and spatial feeling of the experience: one for the outside environment and one for the inside of the café.
- 2. Sound Effects:** Short sounds triggered through user interactions.
- 3. Voice Recordings:** Narration from Sonia [the café owner] and customers throughout the experience.

CURRENT STATE

Sources in Use: Sound effects and rain ambience currently come from free online sound libraries. The interior ambient track is a real recording from Café Le Jardin de Sonia.

Voice Recordings: Current ones are temporary English placeholders using student voices and will later be replaced with the final French-language recordings.

Interactive demo: <https://games.luca-cdrocha.ch/ooops/>

Current sound assets: <https://github.com/LucaCDRocha/head-md-care/tree/main/unity/ooops/Assets/Sounds>

SOUNDS NEEDED

The following sounds are already implemented as first versions, but need to be refined or re-produced to ensure a coherent experience.

Scene Outside:

- Rain [ambient] — quiet, soft, and melancholic rather than dramatic, with variations [rain hitting the café marquee, pavement, and nearby street surfaces]; can also be combined with subtle street traffic noises
- Door opening & closing [interaction] — creaking, should feel natural

Scene Inside:

- Café background [ambient] — can include elements such as coffee machine, cutlery and dish noises, and background music. If customer chatter is added, it should remain indistinct and mumbled so that Sonia’s and the customers’ voice narrations always stay clearly understandable. -> *The existing real café recording could serve as the base layer.*
- Coffee sip [interaction]
- Coffee mug hitting the table
- Object breaking — important story moment; should feel noticeable without sounding too exaggerated or artificial
- Rewind / Going back in time — visually the calendar moves backward in time, shelves gradually empty
- Snap [interaction] — short sound effect triggered each time a shard is placed via ‘drag and drop’ to repair the broken object
- Shard click [invalid interaction] — short click sound triggered when a user ‘taps’ on a shard instead of ‘dragging and dropping’ it, providing feedback that the shard is interactive but requires a different interaction method

SOUNDS TO BE TESTED

The following sounds are currently only conceptual. It would be valuable to produce and test them in order to evaluate whether they enhance the interactions or become distracting.

- Object click [interaction] — short click sound triggered when a user ‘taps’ on an interactive object
- ‘ID card’ objects [= objects without voice narration] — individual [short] sounds for each object to make them feel more alive; to be tested initially for gnome, train, and elephant
- Zoom in & out — subtle audio effect that accompanies camera movement when zooming into an object or returning to the main view